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2026 Robot Vacuum Buying Guide: Roomba vs Shark Comparison

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Tired of constantly pushing a vacuum around while juggling work, kids, and pets? You're not alone. In 2026, robot vacuums have evolved to handle suction, mopping, and self-empty duties, freeing you to focus on what truly matters. The two names on everyone's lips? iRobot's Roomba 115X Combo and Shark's AI Ultra family. Below, we break down how they stack up—so you can decide with confidence.

ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid

Quality	7.0
Features	5.0
Ease of Use	7.0
Design	7.0
Value	6.0

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% Very High Regret Risk

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	Regret Risk: 100%

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

Roomba 115X Combo vs Shark AI Ultra: Quick-Look Decision Matrix



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Feature	Roomba 115X Combo + AutoEmpty Dock	Roomba 115X Combo (no dock)	Shark AI Ultra	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra
Price (Oct 5, 2026)	$199.99	$139.99	$249.99	$239.99
Navigation	iRobot Visual SLAM (iAdapt 3.0)	iRobot Visual SLAM (iAdapt 3.0)	Shark AI Laser Navigation	Shark AI Laser Navigation
Suction Power	Up to 2,000 Pa	Up to 2,000 Pa	Up to 2,200 Pa	Up to 2,200 Pa
Battery Runtime	120 min (max)	120 min (max)	150 min (max)	150 min (max)
Dustbin Capacity	0.5 L (manual empty)	0.5 L (manual empty)	0.6 L (manual empty)	0.6 L (self-empty base holds ~45 days)
Mopping	Yes – vibrating pad, 0.3 L water tank	Yes – vibrating pad, 0.3 L water tank	No	No
Auto-Empty Dock	Included – holds ~30 days of debris	Sold separately	Not available	Included – self-empty base
App & Voice Control	iRobot Home app, Alexa/ Google Assistant	iRobot Home app, Alexa/Google Assistant	SharkClean app, Alexa/Google Assistant	SharkClean app, Alexa/Google Assistant
Noise Level	~68 dB	~68 dB	~70 dB	~70 dB

Is the AutoEmpty Dock Worth the Extra Cost on the Roomba 115X Combo in 2026?

Both Roomba 115X Combo models share the same core cleaning system; the only difference is the presence of the AutoEmpty Dock. The dock adds roughly $60 to the price ($199.99 vs $139.99) but eliminates the need to empty the dustbin after every 2–3 cleaning cycles. According to iRobot’s 2026 usage data, the dock can store debris for up to 30 days in an average-sized home (≈1,200 sq ft) before requiring a bag change. For pet owners or households with high foot traffic, this means fewer interruptions and more consistent suction over time.

If you prefer a lower upfront cost and don’t mind emptying the bin every few runs, the base model saves you $60. But if uninterrupted cleaning cycles matter more—especially with pets or kids—the dock is a worthwhile investment.

Navigation & Suction: Which Tech Matches Your Home?

Roomba’s iAdapt 3.0 visual SLAM builds a detailed map of your space, making it strong in homes with many obstacles and rugs. Shark’s AI Laser Navigation offers comparable accuracy at a similar price point, with slightly higher peak suction (2,200 Pa vs 2,000 Pa) and longer runtime (150 min vs 120 min). If you have large open areas or carpeted rooms, Shark’s edge in power and battery life may sway you. If your home has many tight corners and furniture, Roomba’s visual mapping could feel more intuitive.

Mopping & Floor-Type Performance

The Roomba 115X Combo includes a vibrating mopping pad with a 0.3 L water tank, suitable for light daily mopping on hardwood or tile. Neither Shark model in this comparison offers mopping. If your home features mostly hard floors and you want a "set-it-and-forget-it" suction-and-mop routine, Roomba’s mopping capability is a deciding factor. For carpet-dominant spaces, both brands deliver strong suction, but Shark’s extra 200 Pa and longer runtime may provide more thorough deep cleans.

App, Voice Control & Ecosystem

Both Roomba and Shark support Alexa and Google Assistant voice commands. Roomba’s iRobot Home app offers deeper customization of keep-out zones and cleaning schedules, while SharkClean app focuses on quick start and basic mapping. If you’re already invested in a particular smart-home platform, both integrate seamlessly, but Roomba’s app gives slightly more granular control over no-go areas—useful if you have kids’ play zones or pet feeding stations.

Final Decision: Which Robot Vacuum Fits Your Life?

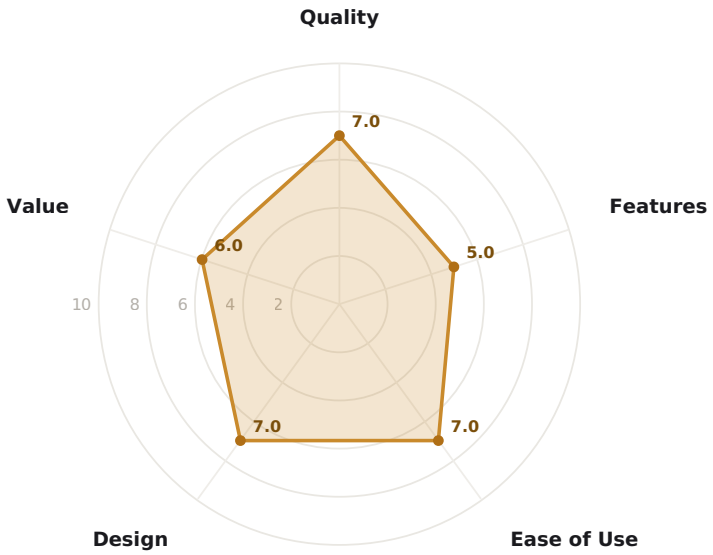
Choose the Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock if: you want minimal maintenance, have pets or kids, value mopping on hard floors, and prefer a unified iRobot ecosystem. Opt for the Roomba 115X Combo (no dock) if: you’re budget-conscious, don’t mind emptying the bin every few cycles, and primarily clean hard floors without mopping. Pick the Shark AI Ultra (or AV2501S) if: you have large carpeted areas, longer runtime is a priority, and you want a self-empty base included at a similar price point.

Ready to buy? Check current Roomba 115X pricing and reviews or see the latest Shark AI Ultra deals.

At a glance

Use Case	Product	Why
Best Overall	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock
Best Value	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop
Premium Pick	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Performance Breakdown



Scores out of 10. Based on the Abvorn Verdict Engine.

Products Mentioned



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

$199.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

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iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

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Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

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Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$239.99

Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

$398.99

iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

Frequently Asked Questions

What is the best robot vacuum?

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock is our current top pick for Robot Vacuums. It earned an Abvorn Verdict score of 6.4/10 for quality, features, ease of use, and at $199.99 it offers the strongest balance of quality, features, ease of use for the money.

Is iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock worth it?

Based on our research, yes for most people. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock scored 6.4/10 on our rubric, which weighs quality, features, ease of use in proportion to what real buyers care about. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

How much should I spend on robot vacuums?

You can get a genuinely good robot vacuum for around $139.99. Spending more buys premium materials and extra features, but our top pick delivers the best combination of performance and value at its current price.

What should I look for when buying robot vacuums?

We score every product on quality, features, ease of use. Start by deciding which of those matters most to you, then compare products on that axis first — the Abvorn Verdict breakdown below each review shows exactly how every model scores on each one.

How does Abvorn research products?

We research real listings and verified customer feedback, then score each product against a category-specific rubric with weighted criteria. Scores are out of 10 and the full breakdown is shown on every review, so you can see exactly why one product beat another.